

these platforms. Excel is an integral part of the entire suite of softwares that Microsoft Office offers.

Ever since the release of its version 5 in 1993, it has, by major consensus, replaced Lotus 1-2-3 to become the industry standard for spreadsheets. Every year, Microsoft introduces a set of updates for Excel in a bid to improve and upgrade its functionality and subsequently keep its industry relevance intact in the process. Sticking to its tradition, Microsoft announced the release of its Office 2019 suite to the general public in the fall of 2018. Subsequently, users were made privy to an exciting assortment of new features and enhancements Excel 2019 had in store for its users. The purpose of this article is to introduce users to all the essential upgrades of Excel 2019 and elaborate upon them for greater clarity and comprehension.

New functions

With the new 2019 version, Excel has brought along with itself six new and improved functions for its users. As a spreadsheet application, Excel is widely recognised for its wide array of native functions which accords users a large degree of mathematical and computational convenience. With every subsequent upgrade, Excel always tries to go a notch further and introduce functions that would help solve voluminous and complicated calculations in a matter of seconds. Excel 2019, presents no exception in this regard. Listed below are the complete set of the six new functions.

CONCAT

The CONCAT function, is essentially an upgrade on the CONCATENATE function that Microsoft Excel used to have earlier. At the superficial level, its appeal lies in it being shorter and thus easier to type than its predecessor. However, there is obviously more to CONCAT than what meets the eye. Upon carrying out a closer inspection you will observe that the newly introduced CONCAT function supports range references, in addition to cell references. Even though it combines the text from multiple ranges and strings, it does not provide delimiter or IgnoreEmpty arguments. Though the CONCAT function more or less replaces the CONCATENATE function, the latter shall continue to stay available for compatibility with earlier versions of Excel. A cautionary note that users should keep in mind while invoking the CONCAT function is that, should the resulting string happen to exceed the stipulated cell limit that is mandated at 32767 characters, then the function will return the #VALUE! error.